

Audible Data Cleaning Project

Power Query Editor | Excel | Data Cleaning Case Study

Presented by
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Cleaned dataset built from the original Audible CSV by standardizing text, converting data types, and handling invalid values.

Dataset And Cleaning Scope

The project focused on transforming raw Audible data into a clean Excel table.

87,489

rows in dataset

8

original columns

9

cleaning questions

14

final columns

Raw columns used

name, author, narrator, time, releasedate, language, stars, price

Main goal: make every column consistent, typed correctly, and useful for future analysis.

Q1: Standardize Name Column

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

the burning maze

After

The Burning Maze

How we did it

- Selected the name column in Power Query.
- Used Transform > Format > Capitalize Each Word.
- Checked that names became consistent for reporting.

Why this step matters

Book names should follow a consistent title style so the final table looks professional and readable.

Q2: Separate Combined Authors

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

Writtenby:JuliaDonaldson,AxelScheffler

After

author1 = Julia Donaldson

author2 = Axel Scheffler

How we did it

- Removed the prefix Writtenby: from the author column.
- Split the author column by comma delimiter.
- Renamed the new columns as author1, author2, and author3.

Why this step matters

If two or more authors are stored in one cell, filtering or grouping by author becomes difficult. Splitting makes analysis easier.

Q3: Format Release Date

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

04-08-2008 as text

After

04-08-2008 as Date

How we did it

- Selected releasedate column.
- Converted it into Date data type.
- Kept the display format as DD-MM-YYYY.

Why this step matters

A proper date column supports sorting, filtering, month/year grouping, and time-based analysis.

Q4: Convert Time To Duration

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

2 hrs and 20 mins

After

0.02:20:00

How we did it

- Created a duration column from the time text.
- Separated hours and minutes from values like hrs and mins.
- Converted the result into Duration data type.

Why this step matters

Duration values can be compared, filtered, averaged, and used to find short or long audiobooks.

Q5: Clean Price Column

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

1,256.00 / Free / text errors

After

1256.00 / null

How we did it

- Removed comma formatting from price values.
- Converted price into Decimal Number or Currency.
- Replaced invalid unknown errors with null instead of forcing 0.

Why this step matters

Null protects average price calculations. Zero is only suitable when the actual meaning is free/no cost.

Q6: Convert Stars To Numeric

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

4.5 out of 5 stars41 ratings

After

Rating Stars = 4.5

How we did it

- Extracted text before 'out of 5'.
- Converted the extracted value into a number.
- Kept Not rated yet rows as null.

Why this step matters

Numeric rating values are needed to calculate average rating and compare book performance.

Q7: Split Narrator Column

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

Narratedby:PhilipPullman,fullcast

After

narrator1 = Philip Pullman
narrator2 = fullcast

How we did it

- Removed the prefix Narratedby: from narrator.
- Split multiple narrators by comma delimiter.
- Renamed output columns as narrator1, narrator2, and narrator3.

Why this step matters

Separate narrator fields help in narrator-wise filtering and make the table cleaner.

Q8: Create Release Info

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

releasedate + language

After

04-08-2008, English

How we did it

- Used Merge Columns or a custom column.
- Combined releasedate and language.
- Named the new column releaseinfo.

Why this step matters

This gives one readable label that combines the release date and language for reporting.

Q9: Format Price To Two Decimals

How this question was solved in Power Query Editor.

Before

468

After

468.00

How we did it

- Selected the cleaned price column.
- Changed the type to Decimal Number or Currency.
- Formatted values consistently with two decimal places.

Why this step matters

Consistent price formatting improves presentation quality and avoids mixed numeric display styles.

Final Question-Wise Summary

Each project requirement was completed with a clear transformation step.

Question	Power Query action	Cleaned output
Q1	Capitalize Each Word	Standardized name
Q2	Remove prefix + split by comma	author1, author2, author3
Q3	Change type to Date	DD-MM-YYYY date
Q4	Create duration from text	time_duration
Q5	Clean numeric values + null errors	price
Q6	Extract rating number	Rating Stars
Q7	Remove prefix + split narrator	narrator1 to narrator3
Q8	Merge date and language	release info
Q9	Format decimals	price with 2 decimals

Cleaning Decisions And Logic

The most important decision was using null correctly.

When to use 0

- Use 0 only when it has real meaning.
- Example: Free price can be treated as 0.
- 0 should not be used for unknown values.

When to use null

Use null when the value is missing, not rated, invalid, or unknown. Null is ignored in averages, so it protects the analysis from incorrect results.

Example: Not rated yet should remain null, not 0, because 0 would reduce the average rating wrongly.

Final Output

The Audible dataset is now ready for analysis and dashboard creation.

87,489

cleaned rows

14

final columns

Power Query Editor

tool used

Ready

for submission

Final cleaned fields

name, author1 to author3, narrator1 to narrator3, releasedate, language, time duration, Rating Stars, rating_count, price, release info

Cleaned Data Link:-

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1XRB2mmSej0g36XJqAg0Zzg38OdxnLOJS/edit?usp=sharing&oid=114825934083514305285&rtpof=true&sd=true>

Thank You!!

A handwritten signature consisting of two parallel, slightly curved lines, followed by a simple smiley face drawn with a circle and two dots for eyes and a curved line for a mouth.